A Quack Beside the Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 6

The duck quacked beside two sheltered notes. One marked a rest bay; the other showed the direct path to the hill lodging. Nib nodded politely at every quack and nearly turned in three directions at once. Lark held the guide still so the printed clue could have a turn.

“Very clear quacking,” Nib insisted politely. “A useful word is clearer still,” Lark murmured.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

yes

“Here qu writes the two familiar sounds /k/ and /w/ close together,” Lark modeled clearly. “Blend them into quack and quick. It isn't the letter name, and it isn't one new sound. Queen uses the ee team we already met.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try quit, quick, quack, queen. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read quack on the route label,” Lark invited gently. “Match it to the duck marker, then check where its path leads.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can quack. Pat can quit.**

“Which friend can stop?” Lark asked warmly. “Find the word that tells you.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The duck marker belonged beside the direct lodging path. Nib waved goodbye and followed the note rather than the loudest greeting. The van reached a level parking space below the hill lodging. The covered glass and fittings were intact. A fixed lifting frame stood beside the platform above, ready for the final part of their journey.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write quack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the duck's marker and the lodging turn. Nib parked the van before studying the lifting frame. The correct path was found, and now the glass needed a proper lifting attachment.